

# Pedro I. R. Luz de Castro

Updated: August 26, 2026

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| CONTACT INFORMATION             | Department of Political Science<br>6756 Haven Hall<br>505 South State Street<br>Ann Arbor, MI 48104                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Phone: 734-492-2304<br>Email: <a href="mailto:pldc@umich.edu">pldc@umich.edu</a><br> <a href="http://pedroluzdecastro.com">pedroluzdecastro.com</a> |
| RESEARCH INTERESTS              | Political economy of development; state formation and fiscal capacity; political geography; territorial governance, armed conflict, and criminal governance.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| EDUCATION                       | <b>University of Michigan</b> , Ann Arbor, MI<br>Ph.D., Political Science<br>M.A., Applied Economics<br><b>University of Brasília</b> , Brasília, Brazil<br>LL.M., Law<br>LL.B., Law                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Expected 2028<br>2025<br><br>2022<br>2018                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| WORKING PAPERS                  | “Fiscal Extraction under Partial Sovereignty: Evidence from Criminal Territories in Rio de Janeiro”<br>Examines when territorial control translates into fiscal extraction and how transaction mobility constrains that power. Uses staggered territorial takeovers and spatial price data from Rio de Janeiro.                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| WORKS IN PROGRESS               | “Municipal Taxation and Firm Organization”<br>“Armed-Actor Rule and Governance Observations”                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| SELECTED RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS | Political Economy and the Environment Group, University of Michigan<br>Interdisciplinary Workshop on Comparative Politics, University of Michigan                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | April 2026<br>2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| TEACHING EXPERIENCE             | <i>Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan</i><br>International Economic Relations<br>Introduction to Comparative Politics<br>Data Science for International Studies<br>Introduction to World Politics<br>Quantitative Empirical Methods of Political Science<br><i>Instructional Aide, ICPSR Summer Program</i><br>Introduction to Python<br>Introduction to the R Statistical Computing Environment<br>Programming for Legal Research Workshop, University of Brasília | Fall 2024<br>Winter 2024<br>Fall 2023<br>Winter 2023<br>Fall 2022<br><br>Summer 2023<br>Summer 2023<br>2020                                                                                                                          |

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| RESEARCH<br>EXPERIENCE               | Graduate Student Research Assistant<br><i>Supervisor: George Tsebelis</i>                                                                  | 2024–Present                                                                                             |
|                                      | Graduate Student Research Assistant<br><i>Supervisor: Robert J. Franzese, Jr.</i>                                                          | Summer 2023                                                                                              |
|                                      | Graduate Student Research Assistant<br><i>Supervisor: Deborah Beim</i>                                                                     | Summer 2022                                                                                              |
| FELLOWSHIPS,<br>AWARDS AND<br>HONORS | Oskar Morgenstern Fellowship, Mercatus Center                                                                                              | 2023–2024                                                                                                |
|                                      | ISR–Rackham Summer Training Award                                                                                                          | 2023                                                                                                     |
|                                      | Graduate Research Fellowship, University of Brasília                                                                                       | 2019–2021                                                                                                |
|                                      | Undergraduate Research Fellowship, University of Brasília                                                                                  | 2015–2016                                                                                                |
| SERVICE                              | Graduate Student Coordinator, Political Economy Workshop                                                                                   | 2024–Present                                                                                             |
|                                      | Graduate Student Coordinator, Interdisciplinary Workshop on<br>Comparative Politics                                                        | 2024–2025                                                                                                |
|                                      | Graduate Admissions Committee, Department of Political<br>Science                                                                          | 2023–2024                                                                                                |
|                                      | Editor, University of Brasília Student Law Review                                                                                          | 2017                                                                                                     |
| SKILLS                               | <i>Technical:</i> Python, R, git, Stata, $\text{\LaTeX}$<br><i>Language:</i> Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate) |                                                                                                          |
| REFERENCES                           | <b>Mark Dincecco</b><br>Professor<br>Political Science<br>University of Michigan<br>dincecco@umich.edu                                     | <b>George Tsebelis</b><br>Professor<br>Political Science<br>University of Michigan<br>tsebelis@umich.edu |
|                                      | <b>Edgar Franco-Vivanco</b><br>Assistant Professor<br>Political Science<br>University of Michigan<br>efrancov@umich.edu                    | <b>Cesi Cruz</b><br>Associate Professor<br>Political Science<br>University of Michigan<br>cesi@umich.edu |